

EMT QUICK REFERENCE CARDS

Printable Study Guide for EMT Students

CARD 1: Normal Adult Vital Signs

Parameter	Normal Range
Heart Rate	60-100 bpm
Blood Pressure	90/60 - 120/80 mmHg
Respiratory Rate	12-20 breaths/min
SpO2	95-100%
Temperature	97.8-99.1 F (36.5-37.3 C)
Glasgow Coma Scale	15 (E4V5M6)

CARD 1B: Pediatric Vital Signs by Age

Age	HR (bpm)	RR (/min)	SBP (mmHg)
Newborn (0-1 mo)	100-160	30-60	60-90
Infant (1-12 mo)	100-160	30-50	70-100
Toddler (1-3 yr)	80-130	20-30	80-110
Preschool (3-6 yr)	80-120	20-25	80-110
School Age (6-12)	70-110	15-20	90-120
Adolescent (12+)	60-100	12-20	100-120

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CARD 2: Glasgow Coma Scale (GCS)

Component	Response	Score
Eye Opening (E)	Spontaneous	4
	To verbal command	3
	To pain	2
	None	1
Verbal Response (V)	Oriented	5
	Confused	4
	Inappropriate words	3
	Incomprehensible sounds	2
Motor Response (M)	None	1
	Obeys commands	6
	Localizes pain	5
	Withdraws from pain	4
	Flexion (decorticate)	3
	Extension (decerebrate)	2
	None	1

Total GCS Range: 3-15

GCS ≤ 8 = Consider intubation. Score of 15 does NOT rule out serious pathology.

CARD 2B: APGAR Score

Component	0 points	1 point	2 points
Appearance (Color)	Blue/pale	Blue ext, pink body	Completely pink
Pulse	Absent	< 100 bpm	≥ 100 bpm
Grimace (Reflex)	No response	Grimace	Cry/cough
Activity (Tone)	Limp	Some flexion	Active motion
Respiration	Absent	Slow/irregular	Strong cry

Scoring: 7-10 = Normal | 4-6 = Moderate depression | 0-3 = Severe depression

Scored at 1 and 5 minutes after birth.

CARD 3: Systematic Patient Assessment

Scene Size-Up (Before Patient Contact):

- Scene safety (BSI: Body Substance Isolation)
- Mechanism of injury / Nature of illness
- Number of patients
- Additional resources needed

Primary Assessment (ABCDE):

- A - Airway: Patent? Obstructed? Need adjunct?
- B - Breathing: Rate, quality, symmetry, SpO2
- C - Circulation: Pulse, skin signs, bleeding control
- D - Disability: GCS/AVPU, pupil response
- E - Expose/Environment: Undress as needed, prevent hypothermia

Secondary Assessment:

- Vital signs (full set)
- History: OPQRST + SAMPLE
- Head-to-toe physical exam
- Focused exam based on chief complaint

Reassessment:

- Repeat primary assessment every 5 min (unstable) or 15 min (stable)
- Reassess interventions
- Trend vital signs

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CARD 4: Common EMS Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning	Abbreviation	Meaning
AED	Automated External Defibrillator	BLS	Basic Life Support
BP	Blood Pressure	BVM	Bag Valve Mask
C-collar	Cervical Collar	CC	Chief Complaint
CPR	Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation	Dx	Diagnosis
EKG/ECG	Electrocardiogram	ETA	Est Time of Arrival
GCS	Glasgow Coma Scale	HR	Heart Rate
IM	Intramuscular	IO	Intraosseous
IV	Intravenous	LOC	Level of Consciousness
MOI	Mechanism of Injury	NPO	Nothing by Mouth
NRB	Non-Rebreather Mask	NS	Normal Saline
O2	Oxygen	OPQRST	Onset, Prov, Qual, Rad, Sev, Time
PRN	As Needed	PT	Patient
RR	Respiratory Rate	Rx	Treatment/Prescription
SAMPLE	Sx, Allerg, Meds, PMH, Last oral, Events	SpO2	Oxygen Saturation
SQ/SC	Subcutaneous	SVT	Supraventricular Tachycardia
Tx	Treatment	VS	Vital Signs

CARD 5: Stroke Scale & Cardiac Algorithms

Cincinnati Prehospital Stroke Scale

Any ONE positive = Stroke Alert

- Facial Droop: Ask patient to smile. One side droops?
- Arm Drift: Ask patient to close eyes and hold both arms out for 10 sec. One arm drifts?
- Abnormal Speech: Ask patient to repeat a simple sentence. Slurred or wrong words?

Adult Cardiac Arrest Algorithm (BLS):

1. Check responsiveness + breathing
2. Activate EMS / call for AED
3. Check pulse (≤ 10 seconds)
4. If no pulse -> Begin CPR (30:2 compression:ventilation)
5. Attach AED ASAP
6. If shockable rhythm (VF/pVT): Shock -> CPR 2 min -> Rhythm check -> Repeat
7. If non-shockable (PEA/Asystole): CPR 2 min -> Epinephrine 1mg IV -> Repeat
8. Continue until ROSC or termination

CARD 6: Trauma Triage & Assessment Mnemonics

START Triage (Simple Triage and Rapid Treatment):

Category	Criteria	Tag Color
Immediate	Unable to walk AND RR>30 OR no radial pulse OR unable to follow commands	Red
Delayed	Unable to walk BUT RR<30, radial pulse present, follows commands	Yellow
Minor	Can walk	Green
Deceased	Not breathing (even after positioning)	Black

OPQRST Pain Assessment:

- O - Onset: When did it start? What were you doing?
- P - Provocation/Palliation: What makes it better/worse?
- Q - Quality: Sharp, dull, crushing, pressure?
- R - Radiation: Does it travel anywhere?
- S - Severity: Scale of 0-10
- T - Time: How long has it been going on?

SAMPLE History:

- S - Symptoms: What is wrong?
- A - Allergies: Any medication/environmental allergies?
- M - Medications: What do you take regularly?
- P - Past Medical History: Relevant conditions?
- L - Last Oral Intake: When did you last eat/drink?
- E - Events: What happened leading up to this?

DISCLAIMER: This product contains general medical reference information for educational purposes only. It does not constitute medical advice, clinical guidance, or protocol. Always follow your local protocols, medical direction, and institutional guidelines. Clinical accuracy should be verified against current evidence-based resources before use in patient care.